Writing Clear and Helpful Customer Replies

Communication Guidelines

Fictional training documentation for a local RAG demonstration.

Tone

Be calm, respectful, concise, and specific. Acknowledge the customer's problem without blaming the customer or making unsupported promises.

Recommended structure

A useful reply usually contains: acknowledgement, verified explanation, numbered next steps, any information needed from the customer, and the next action support will take.

Plain language

Prefer common words and short sentences. Explain technical terms when they are necessary. Avoid internal acronyms unless the customer already uses them.

Accuracy

Distinguish confirmed facts from possibilities. Do not invent product behavior, policy exceptions, refund outcomes, prices, or deadlines. If evidence is missing, say what needs to be checked.

Privacy and security

Never request passwords, MFA codes, CVV codes, or session tokens. Ask for only the information needed to investigate and use approved secure channels.

Example

Instead of “This is not our issue,” write: “I understand this is blocking your work. I’ll check whether the error is related to your account settings or a wider service issue, and I’ll let you know what I find.”